benchmark publications, India has played a pivotal role in advancing traditional medicine research and integration on the global stage.

BRICS Engagement: Strengthening International Cooperation

India's engagement with BRICS nations has emphasized the role of traditional medicine in national healthcare systems. The commitment to collaboration, as evidenced by the **BRICS MoU** and the **BRICS Forum on Traditional Medicine**, highlights India's efforts to support member countries in harnessing the potential of traditional medicine for holistic healthcare.

SCO Conference: Amplifying Trade and Collaboration

The inaugural **Shanghai Cooperation Organisation (SCO) Conference** showcased India's traditional medicine prowess, generating significant trade interest and fostering partnerships with member countries. With over **₹590 crores** in trade commitments and B2B meetings, India's traditional medicine sector gained international recognition and market access. More than 56 exhibitors participated in the event, facilitating **over 50 one-to-one meetings between buyers and sellers**. Additionally, **over 75 meetings** involving participants from **19 countries** including India, Tajikistan, Armenia, Uzbekistan, Mongolia, Kazakhstan, Bahrain & Sri Lanka took place, furthering discussions on traditional medicine trade.

International Day of Yoga: Spreading Wellness Globally

The International Day of Yoga (IDY) has emerged as a global celebration, setting world records and promoting yoga's universal appeal. With Guinness World Records and innovative initiatives like the Ocean Ring of Yoga, India has showcased yoga's transformative power and its role in fostering well-being worldwide. In IDY 2023, organised at UN Headquarters, New York, people did Yoga along with Prime Minister. The event witnessed an overwhelming response from thousands of Yoga enthusiasts from **135 nationalities**, thereby creating a world record. IDY 2023 saw **massive participation of around 23.14 Crore individuals**.

m-Yoga App: Bridging Wellness Through Technology

The Ministry of Ayush's collaboration with WHO on the **m-Yoga App** signifies a digital leap in promoting yoga and wellness globally. This mobile app facilitates **post-pandemic rehabilitation** and aligns with the UN's **Be Healthy, Be Mobile** initiative, advancing universal health coverage through mobile health technology.

Restructuring Ayush Education: Empowering the Future



With landmark legislative reforms and student-centric initiatives, the Ministry of Ayush has revolutionized Ayush education in India. **National Commission for Indian system of Medicine (NCISM)** Act 2020 and National Commission for Homoeopathy (NCH) Act 2020 were enacted in September 2020. Aligning the Ayush education with **NEP 2020**, these commissions are bringing in transparency, efficiency and **student centric education** of a scale and dimensions that is unprecedented in the Ayush sector thus ensuring regulation and standardisation of Ayush education in a very robust manner.

Ayush for Public Health: Delivering Preventive and Promotive Healthcare

The **National Ayush Mission (NAM)** stands as a cornerstone in the Ministry of Ayush's efforts to extend the reach of traditional medicine and integrate it into mainstream public health initiatives. One of the key components of NAM is the establishment and operationalization of Ayush Health and Wellness Centers (rechristened as **Ayushman Arogya Mandir**), aiming to provide comprehensive healthcare services at the grassroots level. Out of the **12500 approved centers, more than 9000** are functional, benefitting over **17 crore people** with Ayush services. Further, **315 Ayush hospitals** and **5023 Ayush dispensaries** have been upgraded to enhance service delivery and infrastructure.

NAM has supported **2375 PHCs, 713 CHCs, and 306 DHs** under the **Ayush Co-location Scheme**. NAM addresses specific health challenges through targeted programs such as **SUPRAJA (Ayush Maternal & Neo-natal Intervention)** to improve pregnancy outcomes and reduce maternal and infant mortality rates, **VAYO MITRA (Ayush Geriatric Healthcare Services)** promoting healthy aging and geriatric care, **AYURVIDYA** aimed at preventive and promotive healthcare through Ayurveda-based interventions, promoting overall well-being and disease prevention and **Ayush Mobile Medical Unit** equipped with Ayush practitioners and facilities.

Research Initiatives: Advancing Evidence-based Practice

The Ministry of Ayush's robust research ecosystem supported by five research councils and their network institutions fosters evidence-based practice and innovation in traditional medicine. Collaborative endeavours with premier institutes, such as the **Ayurgenomics** initiative and **AI-based Ayurtech** projects, demonstrate India's commitment to leveraging **cutting-edge technology** for healthcare advancement. A state of the art Ayush-ICMR Advanced Centre for Integrative Research in all AIIMS across the country has also been established. Moreover, **clinical trials** of Ashwagandha for **long COVID** are also being conducted in a collaborative research which **All India Institute of Ayurveda (AIIA)** is conducting with **London School of Hygiene and Tropical Medicine (LSHTM), UK**.

AI for Health: Harnessing Technology for Holistic Wellness

India's leadership in AI for Health initiatives, including the International Telecommunication Union's **Focus Group on AI in Health**, underscores its commitment to leveraging technology for holistic wellness. Through **AI-based genomics** and digital interventions, India is paving the way for collaborative research and **evidence-based documentation** in traditional medicine.

Ministry of Ayush's journey under the visionary leadership of Sh. Narendra Modi and Sh. Sarbananda Sonowal has been nothing short of transformative. From global standardization to grassroots empowerment, India's traditional medicine sector has made remarkable strides, impacting healthcare systems worldwide. As India continues to champion holistic wellness, its efforts serve as an inspiration for nations embracing traditional medicine in the pursuit of universal health coverage and well-being for all.